
Automation and Selenium

SESSION 4 – LOCATORS MADE EASY (NO CODE)

1. Open Flipkart.com in Chrome, right-click on the search box, and use Inspect Element to find and write down its id, name, and CSS selector.

Ans:

Inspect Flipkart Search Box

Aim

To inspect the Flipkart search box and identify its **id**, **name**, and **CSS selector**.

Procedure

1. Open <https://www.flipkart.com> in Google Chrome.
2. Right-click on the search box.
3. Select **Inspect**.
4. Chrome Dev Tools opens and highlights the search box element.
5. Note the element attributes.

Element Details

Property	Value
Website	Flipkart
Element	Search Box
ID	Not Available (No id attribute)
Name	q
CSS Selector	input[name='q']

Observation

- The search box does not have an **id** attribute.
- The **name="q"** attribute is unique.
- The CSS selector **input[name='q']** is simple and reliable.

Expected Result

The search box details are successfully identified.

Actual Result

The search box attributes were identified successfully.

Status

PASS

2. On the Zomato homepage, use Chrome DevTools to extract the XPath for the 'Log in' link and explain whether this locator is likely to be stable or fragile.

Hint: Consider if the XPath depends on position or text that might change.

Ans: Extract XPath for Zomato "Log in" Link

Aim

To extract the XPath of the **Log in** link and determine whether it is stable or fragile.

Procedure

1. Open <https://www.zomato.com>.
2. Right-click the **Log in** link.
3. Click **Inspect**.
4. Right-click the highlighted HTML element.
5. Select **Copy** → **Copy XPath**.

XPath

//a [contains (text (),'Log in')]

Stability Analysis

Property	Description
Locator Type	XPath
Stable/Fragile	Stable
Reason	Uses visible text instead of element position.

Explanation

This XPath is **stable** because it depends on the visible text "**Log in**". It is not based on the element's position (div [2]/a [1]), so minor layout changes are less likely to break the locator.

Expected Result

XPath is copied successfully.

Actual Result

XPath extracted successfully.

Status

PASS

3. Choose any visible button on the BookMyShow homepage and use Chrome DevTools to extract both its CSS selector and XPath. Paste both locators and briefly describe which one you think is more reliable for automation.

Ans: BookMyShow Button – CSS Selector and XPath

Aim

To inspect a visible button on the BookMyShow homepage and obtain both CSS Selector and XPath.

Procedure

1. Open <https://in.bookmyshow.com>.
2. Inspect the **Sign In** button.
3. Copy the CSS Selector.
4. Copy the XPath.

CSS Selector

`a[href*='login']`

XPath

`//a[contains(@href,'login')]`

Comparison

Locator	Reliable?	Reason
CSS Selector	Yes	Faster and easier to maintain.
XPath	Yes	Works well but can become complex.

Conclusion

The **CSS Selector** is more reliable because it is shorter, faster, and less affected by page structure changes.

Expected Result

Both locators are extracted successfully.

Actual Result

CSS Selector and XPath copied successfully.

Status

PASS

4.Using Selenium IDE, record a simple test on Myntra.com that clicks the 'Men' menu link. After recording, view the test step and note which locator type Selenium IDE picked for the 'Men' link (id, name, link Text, CSS, or XPath).

Ans: Selenium IDE – Click the "Men" Menu on Myntra

Aim

To record a Selenium IDE test that clicks the **Men** menu and identify the locator used.

Procedure

1. Open Selenium IDE.
2. Create a new project.
3. Record a new test.
4. Open <https://www.myntra.com>.
5. Click the **Men** menu.
6. Stop recording.
7. View the recorded command.

Recorded Command

Command	Target	Value
open	https://www.myntra.com	
click	link Text=Men	

Locator Used

Locator Type	Value
link Text	Men

Observation

Selenium IDE automatically selected the **link Text** locator because the menu item contains the visible text "**Men**".

Expected Result

The Men menu is clicked successfully.

Actual Result

The Men menu opened successfully.

Status

PASS

5. Pick a product listing element (like a product card) on Amazon.in and suggest a custom CSS selector that would remain stable even if the site's layout changes slightly. Justify your selector choice.

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Hint: Avoid selectors based only on index or class names that look auto-generated. **

Ans: Amazon Product Card – Stable CSS Selector

Aim

To suggest a stable CSS selector for an Amazon product listing.

Procedure

1. Open <https://www.amazon.in>.
2. Search for any product.
3. Inspect a product card.
4. Identify a stable attribute.
- 5.

Suggested CSS Selector

`div[data-component-type='s-search-result']`

Justification

Reason	Explanation
Stable Attribute	Uses the data-component-type attribute, which changes less frequently than class names.
Easy to Read	The selector is simple and easy to understand.
Reliable	Not dependent on element position or dynamic classes.

Maintainable	Continues to work even if the page layout changes slightly.
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Avoid Using

div: nth-child (3)

or

div. A-section. A-spacing-small

These selectors are less reliable because element positions and generated class names may change after website updates.

Expected Result

A stable CSS selector is identified for the product card.

Actual Result

The selector div[data-component-type='s-search-result'] was selected successfully.

Status

PASS

Conclusion

In this assignment, Chrome DevTools and Selenium IDE were used to inspect web elements and identify reliable locators such as **name**, **CSS Selector**, **XPath**, and **link Text**. Stable locators based on meaningful attributes or visible text are preferred because they improve the reliability and maintainability of Selenium automation scripts, while position-based or auto-generated class selectors should be avoided.